A Moment Beside the River

Last year, my family and I went to Alaska on a cruise. During our visit to Skagway, we took a train through the woods along the edge of a mountain. Below me, green trees covered the slopes under a bright sky. I could feel the cool air flowing around me, carrying the smell of mud and wood. All of a sudden, I saw a river rushing between large gray rocks. The water was so swift, but the trees beside it stood straight and green. In such a cold place, I was surprised that I could not see any yellow leaves. The contrast between the powerful river and the steady trees made me feel the majesty of nature. As the air moved around me, I felt like I was part of the woods instead of just watching them from the train. Looking back, I can see myself in those trees. The rushing water reminds me of the difficulties I face, while the trees remind me to stand firm and not give up when life becomes hard. This connects to Emerson's idea of self-reliance because it encourages me to trust myself and my beliefs when I face pressure. The experience also reminds me of the Over-Soul, the transcendentalist idea that people and nature are connected. For that moment, I felt small beside the mountains and river, but I also felt that I belonged to the world around me.